WHAT ETHICS COMMITTEE MEMBERS SAY

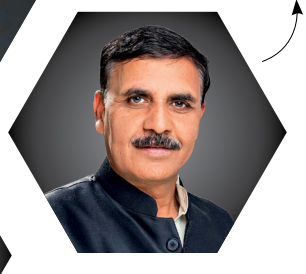
"ON HER OWN, MOITRA TALKED ABOUT THE CONTROVERSY AROUND HER PHOTOS ON SOCIAL MEDIA AND OTHER PERSONAL ISSUES LIKE HER RELATIONSHIP WITH JAI DEHADRAI. WHEN WE SAID WE WERE CONCERNED ONLY ABOUT HER HANDING OVER THE LOGIN TO HIRANANDANI AND NOT HER PERSONAL LIFE, SHE INSISTED SHE NEEDED TO CLARIFY EVERYTHING"

RAJDEEP ROY, *BJP*



"THE PANEL'S AGENDA WAS TO PROBE MOITRA'S ALLEGED UNETHICAL CONDUCT. INSTEAD OF COOPERATING, SHE GOT ANGRY, USED ABUSIVE LANGUAGE AGAINST THE COMMITTEE AND WALKED AWAY"

VINOD SONKAR, *BJP, Ethics Committee chief*





"THE REPORT WAS ADOPTED WITHIN TWO AND A HALF MINUTES. THERE WAS NO DISCUSSION. BEFORE THE COMPLAINANTS WERE QUESTIONED, THERE WAS A DISCUSSION AMONG THE PANEL MEMBERS ON OCT. 26 FOR NEARLY ONE AND A-HALF HOURS. THAT IS NOT RECORDED IN THE REPORT"

DANISH ALI, *BSP*



"We boycotted the deposition proceedings because indecent and irrelevant questions were asked and her right to privacy was violated. Can't remain a mute spectator to Draupadi's *cheerharan*"

GIRIDHARI YADAV, *JD(U)*

to expel her is seen through. Expect drama, the sort that builds up around exemplary rites of punishment, meant primarily for their deterrent effect. Political observers see it as the Union government drawing a line in the sand when it comes to criticism, particularly of Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

But is it having the intended deterrent effect? The TMC leadership, which had so far remained silent on the controversy, has finally backed its leader. By giving her organisational charge, it has put an end to speculation that the TMC may not give her a ticket in the next Lok Sabha polls, while also reposing confidence in her claim that even if disqualified, she will not just win again from Krishnanagar but also double her victory margin. As if in anticipation of the support, Moitra had said on X just days before the move, "Also Mr Adani—don't waste your time telling everyone 'Mahua's ticket will be cut'." The TMC's second-in-command and Mamata Banerjee's nephew, Abhishek Banerjee, has also questioned the ethics panel for recommending her disqualification when a probe was ongoing.

The action against Moitra follows a claim, enthusiastically prosecuted by her bete noire, BJP MP Nishikant Dubey, that she allegedly took bribes in cash and kind from businessman Darshan Hiranandani to target the Adani Group in the Lok Sabha. A key element in the series of misdemeanours alleged against Moitra consists of something she has herself admitted to in media interviews, including with INDIA TODAY: that she shared her login and password for the Lok Sabha member's portal with Hiranandani's office. The accusers say this enabled the Dubai-based billionaire to "post the questions" directly "on her behalf". The scion of the Hiranandani Group is credited with expanding the family's real estate business into areas like energy, where potential exists for a conflict over turf with the Adanis. Ethics panel members even flag his Dubai residency as a matter that scales up the affair to a national security question. Mahua, while dismissing out of hand the allegations of bribe-taking as baseless

THE TMC'S SUPPORT TO MOITRA PUTS AN END TO SPECULATION THAT SHE MAY NOT BE GIVEN A TICKET FOR THE NEXT GENERAL ELECTION